# Marriage and Communication

John P. Kennon
Manuscript excerpt

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by John P. Kennon

## Chapter – Money

“For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.” (Matthew 6:21)

Responsibility

Conversation Starter: Do we both feel equally responsible for our finances?

Suggestion: Shared monthly budget meeting.

Mutual Confidence

Conversation Starter: Do I trust you with every dollar?

Suggestion: Practice full financial transparency.

Control and Simplicity

Conversation Starter: Are we complicating life with unnecessary spending?

Suggestion: Simplify to reduce stress.

Social Justice

Conversation Starter: Are we using our money to bless others?

Suggestion: Pick a cause to support together.

Charity

Conversation Starter: Do we see giving as joy or burden?

Suggestion: Build giving into your lifestyle.

Proper Scales of Value

Conversation Starter: What do we value most in our spending?

Suggestion: Write top 5 priorities as a couple.

Exercise: Rank all six, celebrate one, improve one.

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## Chapter – Time

“Redeeming the time, because the days are evil.” (Ephesians 5:16)

Time for Myself

Conversation Starter: Do I take enough time to recharge?

Suggestion: Guard individuality.

Time for Us

Conversation Starter: How do we protect couple time?

Suggestion: Plan regular date nights.

Time for God

Conversation Starter: How much of our time is dedicated to Him?

Suggestion: Pray together daily.

Time to Love

Conversation Starter: Do I make time to express affection?

Suggestion: Show affection daily.

Time to Pray

Conversation Starter: Are we praying together enough?

Suggestion: Schedule prayer times.

Time to Work

Conversation Starter: Is work balanced with home?

Suggestion: Balance diligence and rest.

Time to Rest

Conversation Starter: Are we honoring Sabbath rest?

Suggestion: Practice rest rhythms.

Time to Talk

Conversation Starter: Do we set time aside for deep talks?

Suggestion: Prioritize intentional conversation.

Time to be Alone

Conversation Starter: Do we respect solitude?

Suggestion: Encourage healthy space.

Exercise: Each spouse maps a weekly 'time pie chart.' Compare balance.

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## Chapter – Sexual Relationship

“Let the husband render unto the wife due benevolence: and likewise also the wife unto the husband.” (1 Corinthians 7:3)

Freedom to Discuss

Conversation Starter: Do we talk openly about intimacy?

Suggestion: Keep conversation shame-free.

Birth Control Decisions

Conversation Starter: Are we united in family planning?

Suggestion: Decide prayerfully together.

Frequency of Intercourse

Conversation Starter: Are we satisfied with our rhythm?

Suggestion: Balance desire with grace.

Preparation

Conversation Starter: Do we prepare emotionally and physically?

Suggestion: Set the mood with care.

Atmosphere

Conversation Starter: Is our environment intimacy-friendly?

Suggestion: Create spaces of peace.

Tenderness

Conversation Starter: Do I show affection beyond the bedroom?

Suggestion: Practice daily tenderness.

Mutual Satisfaction

Conversation Starter: Are we both fulfilled?

Suggestion: Seek shared joy, not selfishness.

Exercise: Write three non-physical ways your spouse makes you feel loved. Share aloud.

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## Chapter – Work

“Commit your work to the Lord, and your plans will be established.” (Proverbs 16:3)

Mutual Interest

Conversation Starter: Do we care about each other’s work?

Suggestion: Ask about each other’s day.

Using Work as Escape

Conversation Starter: Do I hide in my work?

Suggestion: Guard against avoidance.

Overtime

Conversation Starter: Is overtime hurting us?

Suggestion: Count the cost together.

Being Late for Dinner

Conversation Starter: Do I respect family mealtime?

Suggestion: Make punctuality a priority.

Work Over Family

Conversation Starter: Does work come first?

Suggestion: Keep marriage ahead of career.